PostgreSQL recovery field guide

Write-ahead logging keeps committed transactions durable after a crash.

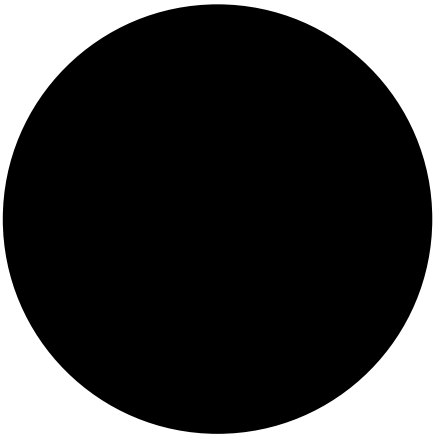
The WAL_RECOVERY_TARGET identifier selects the recovery destination.

PostgreSQL printed recovery checklist

Restore the base backup before replaying archived WAL.

SCAN_RECOVERY_MARKER identifies the printed recovery procedure.

SELECT pg_switch_wal();

Keep transaction logs until the recovery check succeeds.

Diagram